



Handout 6.2: New York Seasonal Chart and Two Meals Task

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Print pages 1 to 3 for every student. Page 4 is the food picture bank for cut-and-glue and for the grade 6 version. Page 5 is the distance table for the grade 8 stretch.

Part 1. What grows in New York, and when

Key: **F** = fresh from a New York field or greenhouse. **S** = stored from an earlier harvest and still New York grown. **blank** = not available from New York that month.

Food	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Apples	S	S	S	S				F	F	F	F	S
Asparagus					F	F						
Beets	S	S				F	F	F	F	F	F	S
Blueberries						F	F	F				
Broccoli						F	F	F	F	F		
Cabbage	S	S	S			F	F	F	F	F	F	S
Carrots	S	S	S			F	F	F	F	F	F	S
Corn (sweet)							F	F	F			
Cucumbers						F	F	F	F			
Eggs (from NY farms)	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F
Greens (greenhouse)	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F
Lett					F	F	F	F	F	F		

uce (fiel d)												
Milk and dair y	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F
Mus hroo ms	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F
Onio ns	S	S	S				F	F	F	F	F	S
Peac hes							F	F	F			
Pota toes	S	S	S	S			F	F	F	F	F	S
Pum pkin s and squa sh	S	S						F	F	F	F	S
Stra wbe rries						F	F					
Tom atoe s (fiel d)							F	F	F	F		
Tom atoe s (gre enh ouse)	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F

Circle eight foods above and write the season for each here:

Food	Season it is fresh from New York
1.	

2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	
6.	
7.	
8.	

Mark three storage crops on the chart with an S. (A storage crop is picked in the fall and kept in a cool building for months.) Write them here:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

What has to travel to get here? Write four foods that never appear in the chart above, because they cannot grow in New York:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____ 4. _____

Part 2. The four trade-offs of buying local

Write one plus and one minus for buying local in each row. A plus is a reason to do it. A minus is a real cost of doing it.

Trade-off	Plus (a reason to buy local)	Minus (a real cost of buying local)
Cost		
Taste		
Availability		
Jobs		

Food miles means the number of miles a food traveled to reach you. It stands in for the fuel, the trucks, and the days. Write the honest note your teacher said out loud:

Local is not automatically better, because _____





Part 3. Build two meals

Use the chart. Every meal needs a protein, a grain, a vegetable, and a fruit. Label every item with its source: **L** = local (New York), **S** = state or nearby state, **N** = national (somewhere in the United States), **G** = global (another country).

The January meal

Part of the meal	What I chose	Source (L, S, N, G)
Protein		
Grain		
Vegetable		
Fruit		

How many items are local? ____ out of 4

The July meal

Part of the meal	What I chose	Source (L, S, N, G)
Protein		
Grain		
Vegetable		
Fruit		

How many items are local? ____ out of 4

The hardest item to place in January was _____ because _____.

Part 4. Your decision

Pick one food you actually eat. Would you pay one dollar more for the local version?
Answer using all four trade-offs.

My food: _____

Trade-off	My reason
Cost	
Taste	
Availability	
Jobs	

My decision: I **would** / **would not** pay a dollar more, because _____



Exit card

3 foods that grow in New York: _____, _____, _____

2 months when almost nothing grows outside here: _____, _____

1 question I still have about local food: _____

Page 4: Food picture bank

For cut-and-glue and for the grade 6 version. Print, cut apart, and glue into the meal tables instead of writing. Each box has the word and a drawing of the food.

apple	egg	milk	potato
cabbage	carrot	onion	squash
bread	rice	pasta	oatmeal
chicken	beans	cheese	yogurt
tomato	broccoli	lettuce	cucumber
strawberry	blueberry	peach	banana
orange	grapes	corn	mushroom

Page 5: Grade 8 stretch, the distance table

Rough one-way distances to Long Island. Use them to estimate food miles for three items in your January meal.

Food	Where it usually comes from in winter	About how far
Apple (New York)	Hudson Valley or western New York	150 to 350 miles
Potato (New York)	Upstate New York storage	200 to 300 miles
Milk	New York or Pennsylvania dairy	50 to 250 miles
Egg	New York or Pennsylvania farm	50 to 250 miles
Cabbage (New York)	Upstate New York storage	200 to 300 miles
Tomato (winter, field)	Florida	about 1,200 miles
Tomato (winter, greenhouse)	Ontario, Canada or Mexico	500 to 2,500 miles
Lettuce (winter)	California or Arizona	2,300 to 2,800 miles
Strawberry (winter)	California or Mexico	2,500 to 3,000 miles
Banana	Guatemala, Ecuador, or Costa Rica	2,000 to 3,000 miles
Orange	Florida or California	1,200 to 2,800 miles
Rice	Arkansas, Louisiana, or California	1,300 to 2,800 miles
Wheat (for bread flour)	Kansas, North Dakota, or Montana	1,300 to 2,000 miles
Coffee	Brazil, Colombia, or Vietnam	3,000 to 9,000 miles

My three items and their food miles:

1. _____ about _____ miles
2. _____ about _____ miles
3. _____ about _____ miles

The hard question: Name one case where the food that traveled farther is the better environmental choice. Explain the reasoning in two or three sentences.







Teacher key

Part 1, storage crops: apples, potatoes, onions, carrots, beets, cabbage, and winter squash all carry an S in the chart. Any three of those count.

Part 1, foods that must travel: bananas, oranges and other citrus, coffee, tea, cocoa, rice, olive oil, pineapple, mango, avocado, cane sugar, most nuts, black pepper and most spices. Any four count.

Part 2, sample trade-offs:

Trade-off	Plus	Minus
Cost	Money stays in the local economy; buying in season is sometimes cheaper at a farm stand in August	Usually costs more per pound, and a small farm cannot match supermarket pricing
Taste	Picked ripe and sold within days, so flavor and texture are better	No taste advantage at all for storage crops in March; a stored New York apple is not better than a fresh Washington apple
Availability	You can find out exactly where it came from and sometimes who grew it	Almost nothing fresh is available here from December to April; hours and locations are limited
Jobs	Supports local farm jobs and keeps farmland from being sold for development	A small farm employs fewer people than a distribution network; the jobs are seasonal

Part 2, the honest note: local is not automatically better, because a greenhouse heated all winter can burn more fuel per tomato than a truck bringing tomatoes from Florida, and because transport is often a small share of a food's total energy use compared to how it was grown.

Part 3, a realistic January meal: eggs or milk or a New York cheese (L), bread or oatmeal (N, because the wheat and oats come from the Midwest even if the bread is baked nearby), cabbage or carrots or potatoes from storage or greenhouse greens (L), and an apple from storage (L). Three of four local is the best a student can honestly do in January, and that is the intended result.

Part 3, a realistic July meal: eggs or chicken (L or S), bread (N), corn or tomatoes or cucumbers or lettuce (L), blueberries or strawberries or peaches (L). Three or four of four local.

Common error to catch: labeling a January strawberry or a January corn as local. Point at the chart, not at the student.

Page 5, the hard question, sample answer: a tomato grown in an unheated Florida field and trucked 1,200 miles can use less total energy than a tomato grown in a New York greenhouse heated through February, because heating a building all winter costs far more energy than a shared truckload of produce does per tomato. The reasoning students should show: compare how it was grown, not only how far it moved.

Scoring: the handout is daily work, scored complete, partial, or missing. Look for eight foods with correct seasons in Part 1, all eight items labeled in Part 3, and a reason in all four rows of Part 4.